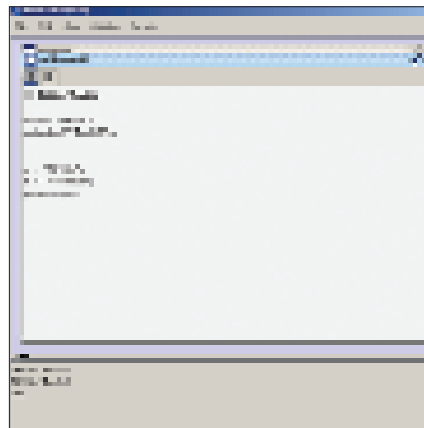


Practice Scripting In Frinika

With scripting support in Frinika, you can just about script anything with Java on it. It's like having your very own little IDE for Java scripting with multiple windows within one parent



You can practice scripting in Frinika's inbuilt scripting feature

window. There are samples you can try too, by clicking on the Presets menu. Run the Play button or click on Run > Execute to run the code.

Increasing Piano Roll View Area

The Piano roll feature is located at the bottom of the screen and has a very small working area. There are a few ways to get more work space into it. One of them is to click and drag the upper extremity of the pane, till you get sufficient space. By default, the view is zoomed into a small section of the timeline. Click the [-] button, right next to the scrollbar to zoom out and the [+] to zoom in. There is a zoom button on the top section of the Piano roll pane. Ultimately, you can also make the Piano pane much larger, by pressing the maximise button—the same button will do the trick for all other panes.

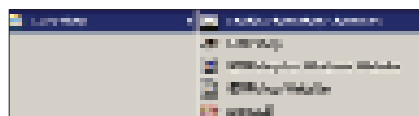
Importing And Exporting

When all the work is done, it is time to export the tracks to your favourite format. If click on File > Export Audio, you'll notice that there is no MP3 format in the dropdown menu for formats. You can choose to save as WAV but that could be space consuming, so it's a better option to save the file in the OGG format.

When it comes to importing formats, Frinika can import all kinds of sequenced modules such as MOD, S3M, XM, STM and IT. You can do it by going to File > Import Module. You can also import MIDI files by clicking Import MIDIs.

GIMPSHOP

Although GIMP has been popularly known as a free, open source replacement for Photoshop meant for Linux, its workflow has never exactly resembled Photoshop. GIMP has been ported to Windows and so has GIMPshop—its software that developers got to finally work under one big window and make it a lot like Photoshop. The features of GIMP are all still there, they are just a little easier to access for people who've been using Photoshop so far.



Photoshop shortcuts can be enabled by running a shortcut in the Windows Start menu

Keyboard Shortcuts

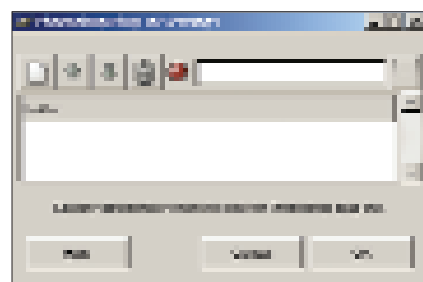
One of the biggest differences with Photoshop and any other image editing software for that matter is the use of keyboard shortcuts. Most advanced users will not run around searching for features in menus, they remember them by shortcuts. You can have Photoshop shortcuts set for GIMPshop by clicking on Start > All Programs > GIMPshop > Enable Photoshop Shortcuts. Restart GIMPshop. If that doesn't work for you, you can still go to File > Preferences. Click on Interface on the left, and then Configure Keyboard Shortcuts. Here, all the shortcuts can be customised as per your choice. Some other configuration changes to the behaviour of the mouse and keyboard can also be done by clicking on File > Preferences > Input Devices > Input Controllers.

Making Docks

GIMPshop allows the menus on the interface to be undocked, which allows quick access to the tools within them. Say you want to use the Xtns menu and some of the scripts in it. Click the Xtns menu and click the dotted line on top of the menu. The menu will then undock from the menu. You can move it to the side and access all the features directly from there. If you right click on the image you're working on, a separate menu with all the items in the standard menu on top will be displayed, which can also be undocked.

Customising GIMPshop

One of the significant changes with GIMPshop is the big window, which



Photoshop plugins can be used under GIMP using the 3rd party plugin—PSPI

holds all the GIMP tools together. The background colour for this window can be to be a little pleasing on the eyes. Click on Edit > Background Color. Choose a colour and click OK. You can also have all the toolbars and windows snap to the edges if you click on Edit > Snap GIMP Windows.

Using Photoshop Plugins

Even though GIMP can do a lot of what Photoshop can do, there are some plugins that add additional features to Photoshop. Photoshop plugins can be used in GIMP as well but for that an additional plugin for GIMP or GIMPshop needs to be downloaded. It's called PSPI and is available for download for different operating systems at <http://www.gimp.org/~tml/gimp/win32/pspi.html>. Unzip the file into the GIMPshop folder. Now start GIMPshop, and click on Xtns and then on Photoshop Plug-in Settings. Click the New button and then the ... button to browse for the plugins. Click OK when done.

Use Script-Fu To Generate Designs And Patterns



Performance tweaks can be necessary if large images are opened in GIMP

Scripting is a way to have complex designs and patterns made by GIMPshop. Scripting support is something that is standard in most of today's well-known image editing and 3D-modelling software. Readymade Script-Fu scripts are available in GIMPshop, under the Xtns menu or by



Adobe Photoshop Express

Photoshop, now in a browser

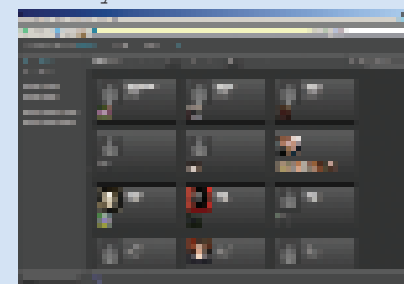
Rossi Fernandes

Adobe's domination over computer graphics just went online. Adobe Photoshop Express (<https://www.photoshop.com/express/>) is a free online image editing service that allows you to use some of Photoshop's noteworthy features. Not only that, you can also get 2 GB of free online space and an easy to remember <http://<your-choice>.photoshop.com> domain to go with it!

Uploading And Importing Photos

Being an online service, all the photos that you want to edit need to be uploaded to the service. Photoshop Express has a nice way of doing this. Click on the Upload Photos link, and then browse to the folder where you have stored the photos. Hold down [Ctrl] and select the multiple images that you want to upload, then click Open. In the new window, choose whether you want to upload the photos into a new album or an existing one. If it's an existing one, use the dropdown menu and select it. Click Upload. The uploading process will take place, and a status display will be shown as well.

Photos can also be imported from other photo hosting sites such as Photobucket, Picasa and the popular social networking site—Facebook. Click on Login for the corresponding external service and login to your account. To see all the photos, click on Library > All Photos link.



Clicking on an album starts a slideshow of that album

Browsing Galleries

The other notable feature of Photoshop Express is its community. All albums that are shared can be viewed by other users of Photoshop Express. Slideshows are a small part

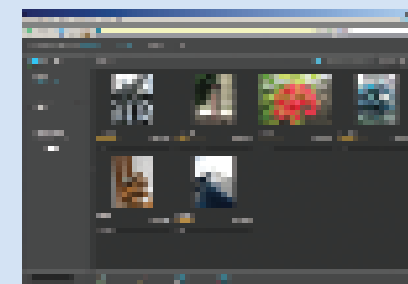
of the features offered by Adobe. Click on Browse to browse through the list of users and galleries. Click on the smaller thumbnails under each user to visit that particular gallery. To set the duration for each slide in the gallery, use the bar on the right top. Enabling captions can be done by clicking the checkbox. If you click the Settings button on the right bottom of the screen, you can set the type of transition effect for the slideshow. Galleries can be linked as well and set as favourite using the links below each album.

Creating Albums

Albums are an easy way to categorise images as well as share them with other users. Creating albums can be done by clicking on the + icon next to Albums under My Photos and enter a name for the album. To delete an album at anytime, click on Albums. Then, click on the album and press the Del key or click on Remove Album.

Adding Ratings And Captions

Photos in your albums can be rated, and you can give them captions too. The captions are also displayed when other users browse through your albums. Click on My Photos to access your photos. Click on the image you want to rate and add captions to. Enter a caption in the text field under each image. Click on the dulled out stars to set a rating for that photo.



Users can rate their photographs and set captions for them

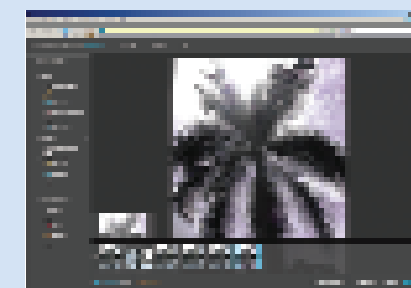
Full Screen

Photoshop Express runs in a browser, and so one of the most obvious drawbacks is the workspace wasted by the browser's menus and toolbars. Fortunately, Photoshop Express can run in a full screen mode without

any obstructions. The small icon on the right top of the screen can be clicked to go into full screen mode. Press that icon again to return to window mode.

The Tools And Effects Of Photoshop Express

Photoshop Express's features don't come close to matching the number of features on the desktop version, but there are still some impressive ones. Double-click on any of your photos to



Photoshop Express stores an interactive history of steps

go into the editing mode. All the tools are visible on the left side of the photo. Presets for each of the features are available on the top pane. The up arrow icon at the bottom of the screen shows a preview of all the changes made from the original photo. One of the interesting features of Photoshop Express is Pop Color. This tool can replace a particular colour with another. In photos where most of the area is of a particular colour, it works very effectively.

Exporting Photos

When all the editing and colour corrections to the photos are done, you might want to get the images back on your local machine. Click on My Photos to access all your photos. Move the mouse pointer to the bottom of the photo and click on the dropdown for Photo Options and click Download. Select a resolution and click Download. Select a location, enter a name for the file and click Save.

You can use the free Photoshop Express space to host images as well. Click on the same dropdown and click on Link. The link can be used on your personal blog, forums or even Web sites! ■

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